

A photograph of a desk setup. In the center is a clipboard with a black pen resting on it. The clipboard has a sheet of paper with a checklist of ten items, each preceded by a small square box. To the right of the clipboard is a brown ceramic mug filled with coffee, sitting on a dark coaster. To the left of the clipboard is a black smartphone. In the background, there is a potted plant with green leaves and a window showing a cityscape at sunset or sunrise. The lighting is warm and golden.

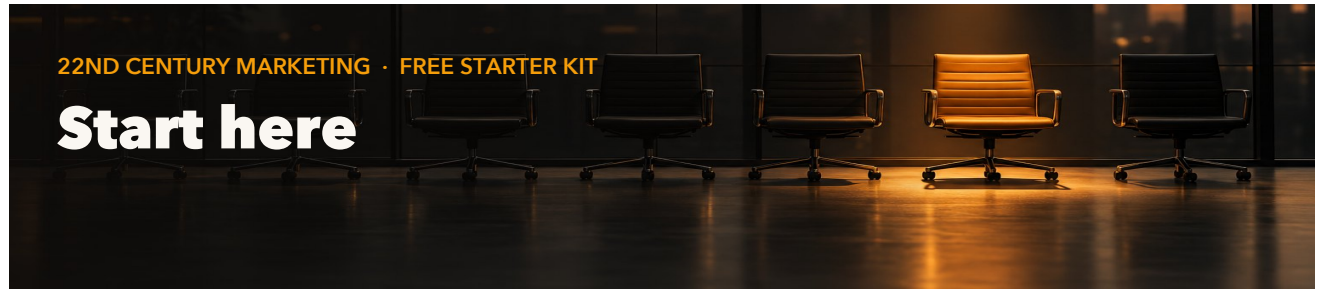
22ND CENTURY MARKETING · FREE STARTER KIT

The CMO Seat Starter Kit

The cost table, the kickoff script, the three numbers, and the benchmark sheet.
The first step of Manual 1.

FREE

Free. Share it with someone who runs ads.



This kit is the first ten pages of a seat you didn't know you could sit in.

It has four things: the cost of the marketing team you'd otherwise hire, the kickoff script a real chief marketing officer runs before spending a dollar, the three numbers that decide whether ads can work for a business, and the benchmark sheet that tells you what "good" looks like. Plus a copy-paste prompt (and a small Claude skill) that runs the kickoff for you.

Read it once. Then run the kickoff on your own business, or on the first client you're thinking about taking on. If you want the rest of the seat, the offer, the creative standard, Google, launch, the dashboard, troubleshooting, and the weekly report, that's Manual 1. The last page tells you what's in it.

The team you're about to replace

Here's what it costs to hire the people who make and run ads for a business. Seven seats: the folks who design the images, write the scripts, write the copy, shoot and cut the video, buy the media, and sit at the top deciding what to do.

\$1,066,000

a year for a middle-of-the-road
seven-seat ad team, fully loaded

\$6,000

a year for the software that now does
six of those seven seats

6 of 7

seats replaced. The seventh, the one
that decides, is yours

In-house ad team, base salaries at low, medium, and high market rates

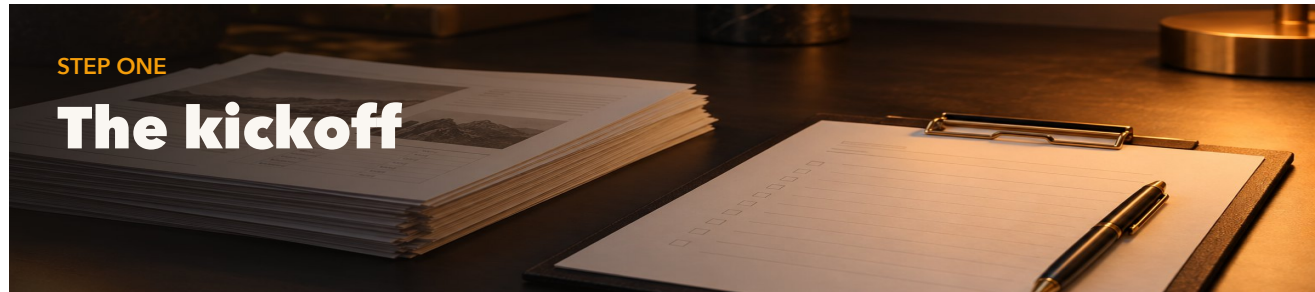
Role	Low	Medium	High
Graphic designer	\$55K	\$70K	\$85K
Ad script writer	\$65K	\$83K	\$100K
Copywriter	\$65K	\$80K	\$95K
Video editor	\$65K	\$83K	\$100K
Video producer / videographer	\$75K	\$98K	\$120K
CMO	\$170K	\$250K	\$420K
Media buyer	\$62K	\$83K	\$105K
Total base payroll	\$557K	\$746K	\$1.025M

Base payroll isn't what they cost you. Add benefits and employer costs, which run roughly 43% on top of salary.

Cost level	Base payroll	Benefits + employer costs (~43%)	Total annual cost
Low	\$557,000	\$239,000	\$796,000
Medium	\$746,000	\$320,000	\$1,066,000
High	\$1,025,000	\$439,000	\$1,464,000

Call it a million dollars a year for a middle-of-the-road team, before they spend a single dollar on actual ads. The software that now does the work of six of those seven seats runs about \$500 a month all-in. About \$6,000 a year against \$1,066,000.

Six of seven. Not seven. The tool replaces the hands: it draws, writes, edits, shoots, and buys. It does not replace the head, the \$250,000 seat that decides what to sell, to whom, and whether it's working. That seat is now yours.



A CMO who doesn't know what a customer is worth is guessing with someone else's money.

So the first thing you do, before you open any software, is collect the numbers. If this is your own business, do this exercise on yourself and be honest. If you're running ads for someone else, this is the kickoff call.

The script, word for word

"Before I build anything, I need to understand this business better than the competitors understand theirs. Some of these questions are about money. Be straight with me, because I can't do this well if I'm guessing."

When someone becomes a new customer, what are they worth on the first sale?

Do they come back? Over a year, what's a good customer worth?

Of that first sale, roughly how much do you keep after direct costs? (gross margin)

How many new customers a month could you actually handle right now? Where does it break?

When a lead comes in (form or call), who answers? How fast? What happens at 6 p.m. or on a Saturday?

Hours, and the area you actually serve?

What are you offering right now to get someone in the door?

Have you run ads before? What happened, what did you spend, do you still have the accounts?

Access and assets to collect

- ☐ Meta Business Manager, Facebook Page, Instagram, ad account
- ☐ Google Ads (or note one must be created)
- ☐ Website URL and who controls it
- ☐ Logo and brand assets
- ☐ Photos and video of the real business, staff, work
- ☐ Where the best reviews live



Everything downstream is built from these. Fill them in before you write a single ad.

1. Break-even ROAS = 1 divided by gross margin

ROAS is return on ad spend: revenue divided by spend. Break-even is the ROAS where the ads pay for themselves. Above it is profit. Without the margin you can tell a business it's getting leads, not that it's making money.

Gross margin	Break-even ROAS
25%	4.0
30%	3.33
35%	2.86
40%	2.5
50%	2.0
60%	1.67
70%	1.43
80%	1.25

2. Maximum affordable cost per lead

Customer value x close rate x gross margin. A roofer whose average job is \$12,000 at 35% margin, closing one lead in five, can pay up to $\$12,000 \times 0.20 \times 0.35 = \text{\$840 per lead}$ and still break even. A restaurant with a \$40 visit at 60% margin closing half its leads can pay \$12. Same math, wildly different budgets. That's why you asked. Aim for half the break-even number or less, so the ads make money after the management cost.

3. Starting daily budget

Work backward from customer value and capacity. If a customer is worth \$12,000 and they can take ten more a month, they can afford real budget. If a customer's worth \$80 on thin margins, go lean. As a floor, you want enough daily spend to produce a handful of leads a day so the platform has data: for most local lead gen that's somewhere around **\$50-\$100 a day** to start, tuned once you see cost per lead against the business's numbers. The right budget is the one where each lead costs less than the profit from the customers those leads become.

Speed-to-lead: the paragraph that makes or breaks everything. MIT's Lead Response Management Study (2007, 15,000+ leads) found the odds of contacting a lead if you call within five minutes versus thirty drop by 100 times. The Harvard Business Review follow-up (2011) audited 2,241 US companies: average response was 42 hours, and 23% never responded at all.

I can send a perfect lead, and if someone calls it back tomorrow afternoon, it's dead. Someone has to be calling these people in minutes. If that can't happen, it's the first problem to solve, before ads.



Pixel first: if tracking is broken, every other number is a lie.

Then read these, in this order: spend, leads, CPL against your max affordable CPL, CTR and hook rate, CPM, ROAS against break-even.

Metric	What it is
CPM	Cost per 1,000 impressions. The price of attention.
CTR	Click-through rate. Whether the ad is compelling.

Metric	What it is
CPC	Cost per click.
CPL	Cost per lead. Usually your headline number.
CVR	Conversion rate: of those who clicked or saw the form, the share who became a lead.
ROAS	Return on ad spend: revenue divided by spend. 3.0 means \$3 back per \$1.
Hook rate	3-second video views divided by impressions. ~25% average, 30%+ strong, 40%+ elite, under ~20% the first frame is being scrolled past.
Lead	A person who gave contact info asking to hear from the business. Not a customer.

What "good" looks like

WordStream by LocaliQ analyzes thousands of real campaigns a year; their averages are medians. Meta 2025 (leads objective): CPL \$27.66, CVR 7.72%, CPC \$1.92. Google 2026: CPC \$5.42, CTR 6.64%, CVR 8.18%, CPL about \$66.69. Google leads cost more; that's the price of intent. Directional. Your job is to beat these, not match them.

Niche	Starter offer	Meta CPL (2025)	Google CPC / CPL (2026)	Usually goes wrong
Dentist	\$79 exam + X-rays + cleaning	~\$76.71	~\$8.00 / ~\$72.97	High CPL scares the owner; anchor on lifetime value
Med spa	First Botox visit \$9/unit; free consult + \$100 credit	~\$51	~\$6.17 / ~\$67.36	Policy flags on skin claims
HVAC	Free estimate + \$89 tune-up	~\$41.26	~\$8.33 / ~\$90.92	Seasonal swings; don't over-scale
Roofer	Free inspection + drone report	~\$41.26	~\$8.33 / ~\$90.92	Lead quality; use Higher Intent form
Restaurant	Free appetizer with two entrees	~\$3.16	~\$2.05 / ~\$30.57	Cheap leads not tied to revenue; track redemptions
Gym	7-day trial + free PT session	~\$52.98	~\$6.17-7.17 / ~\$54.60-67.36	Trials that never convert
Law firm	Free case review; no fee unless we win	~\$18.17	~\$9.87 / ~\$131.63	Google is expensive and strict; lean on Meta
Real estate	Free instant home valuation	~\$16.61	~\$3.22 / ~\$102.51	Long time-to-close; set nurture expectations
Auto repair	Free brake inspection; \$49 oil change	track your own	~\$4.35 / ~\$29.96	Low-margin offers need the counter upsell



Two ways. The zip in this download contains a small Claude skill, **cmo-kickoff**, that interviews you, does the three-number math, and hands back the filled-in worksheet. Or paste the prompt below into Claude or ChatGPT.

Install the skill

- **Claude.ai:** Settings, then Capabilities or Skills, then upload **cmo-kickoff.skill**.
- **Claude Code:** unzip so the folder sits at `~/.claude/skills/cmo-kickoff/`, then say "run the kickoff for my HVAC client."

Or paste this prompt

You are the chief marketing officer for a local business that is about to run Meta and Google ads. Before recommending anything, interview me to fill in this kickoff worksheet, a few questions at a time, defining any term the first time you use it:

- customer value on the first sale, and over a year
- gross margin on that first sale
- monthly capacity for new customers, and where it breaks
- who answers a new lead, how fast, and what happens after hours
- hours and service area
- the current offer
- past ad history and account access

Then compute: break-even ROAS (1 divided by gross margin), maximum affordable cost per lead (customer value x close rate x margin, stating the close rate you assumed), and a starting daily budget worked back from value and capacity (floor about \$50-\$100/day for most local lead gen). Finish with the filled-in worksheet, those three numbers, and a list of what is still missing. Never invent my numbers; ask for ballparks.



The kickoff is the first of twenty sections. The other nineteen are the rest of the CMO seat.

The decisions the software can't make and the standard you judge its work against. Direct response advertising for local businesses, fulfilled with ToMarket.io, though the judgment applies to any AI ad tool.

Inside the \$39 bundle

- **The 20-page manual.** Seat by seat, what each person did and what does it now. Setting expectations in writing. The offer (Hormozi's value equation, lead-gen vs direct sale, offer templates by niche). Who the ads are talking to. The research the writers used to do. The opening-frame standard, the copy checklist, approved vs sent back. The Google side. Launch. The rules engine and when not to touch it. What you test by hand, in what order. Reading the dashboard. Troubleshooting by symptom. The weekly report and the monthly ROI sentence that renews a contract. Running several businesses at once and the operator's math. Mistakes that get a CMO fired. The niche quick-reference.
- **The cmo-seat Claude skill.** The whole seat as a skill: kickoff, expectations letter, offer and brief, creative review with approve / send back verdicts, Google RSA builder, launch checklist, dashboard read, troubleshooting, weekly report and ROI math, operator schedule.
- **The toolkit.** Fill-in worksheets and templates for every step: kickoff, expectations letter, offer brief, copy checklist, pre-launch checklist, weekly report.
- **The prompt pack.** Nine copy-paste prompts for every workflow, for people who don't install skills.

\$39. One-time. Instant download. Grab it from the same store this kit came from. Reply to the email that delivered this kit if you have a question first.

22ND CENTURY MARKETING

Roemer AI Solutions

Six of the seven seats at that table are now software. The seventh is you.

Feed it a real offer built from real research, approve for the hook, let the engine do the ninety percent, read the numbers against the benchmarks, and tell the truth every week.

Manual 1 is the training for the seat. \$39, one-time, in the same store this kit came from.

Sources for every benchmark and study are in section 20 of the manual.